We continually hear about new technical developments whirling across sectors and introducing changes at a pace faster than expected. While there is a fear of minimal human intervention, there is also an anticipation of faster and accurate work through automation. In today's competitive work environment, organizations are looking for ways to increase their productivity and so many of them are considering new technologies to embed into their business processes and products. Technology is changing not only the way a company does business but also the way people are valued by a company. There are two types of professionals, experts who have a complete knowledge of tech and the others who are evangelists. A Management student is expected to be both, a person with expert knowledge and being able to see where and how technology becomes the catalyst, as well as becoming an evangelist, making technology and processes using technology more inclusive.

WeSchool chooses to look at technology as an Art and Science and teaches the Science of it through programs. Having pioneered the PGDM E-Business program in 2002, WeSchool has over the decade evangelised technology in business – its appreciation, and application, in a way that it helps makes ideas come to life and builds speed, depth and scale. While the Institute's PGDM E-Business, PGDM Research and Business Analytics provide the students strong pillars of understanding new age technology, Data Analysis capabilities, the PGDM Programs in Retail, Healthcare, Media & Entertainment, Rural Management provide for understanding how technology can make an impact across sectors and be manifested to become growth catalysts.

Needless to say, that WeSchool's Technology- In application approach has realised leaders and catalysts viz Mr Shailaz Nag, Founder and CEO Dot Pe, Founder, Phone U. Industry, across sectors be it Healthcare, IT companies, FMCG's, Banking and Financial Institutions, Retail organizations have recruited WeSchool students in roles such as Business Analysts, Customer Success and Technology Catalyst roles.

A LIVING LAB FOR INNOVATION TO SOLVE BIG PROBLEMS IN CONTEXT: Setup in 2015, 'REDX WeSchool' is an Innovation Lab at S. P. Mandali's Prin. L. N. Welingkar Institute of Management Development and Research (WeSchool), is a vibrant ecosystem of Innovation, rolling out new and innovative commercial and citizen-based technologies to create a framework that supports wide-ranging needs of urban populations and corporations. We strive to go beyond known boundaries and disciplines of technology innovation for social impact.

The focus is to leverage:

- Imaging and digital technologies, ultra low-cost hardware, mobile platforms and Internet of Things,
- Design skills like Design Thinking, Design Research, Design ethnography, concept prototyping, Design validation, Localisation, Authentic design and Brand Storytelling
- Artificial Intelligence, Deep Learning, Machine Learning and Computer Vision to develop tech-enabled innovations

we4tech is an internal tech hackathon that is conducted every year for the incoming batch of students right into their first three weeks on campus. Tech tutorials are organized for students from both tech and non-tech backgrounds to help them create tech-based solutions for various business/societal challenges.

We undertake various initiatives within the campus to embed the spirit of tech-led innovation. Eminent experts from various fields share their views with our students. As a result of these initiative, the Institution's Innovation Council (IICs) has consistently scored 4+ star ratings nationally.

Triple Bottom Line – Acting responsibly as citizens and leaders, the mindfulness that requires focus on social and environmental issues as much as on profits. (Planet, People and Profits). The triple bottom line concept has today morphed into the use of 'environmental, social and governance' factors, or ESG, which now forms the bedrock of most sustainable investing processes.

At WeSchool, sustainable businesses, contribution to society and planet impact are built in through learning by doing models such as "grassroot immersion programs in rural India, healthcare sector", the "Global Citizen Leadership program (GCL) delivered across programs. WeSchool built the Global Citizen leader (GCL) program, collaboratively with the Center for Creative Leadership, a global training organization that provides leadership training that is human-centered and transformational. The GCL is an immersive program that every student at WeSchool participates in. The program involves solving real-time challenges, discovering future opportunities for businesses through products, services and uncovering new market spaces. Every year over 150 Live Industry projects are part of this program. This approach of teaching was also recognised for the impact it is making with the students in the Stanford Social Innovation Review as an initiative that is capable of Educating a New Generation of Entrepreneurial Leaders and the National HRD Network, in India.

According to Naukri, the list of the most in-demand and trending tech skills that will offer you a successful career:

- Data Science
- Cloud Computing
- Artificial Intelligence
- DevOps
- Blockchain
- RPA (Robotic Process Automation)
- Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR)
- Cybersecurity





Times today require an integrative thinker to combine Technology + Domain Knowledge (Functional and Domain) + Sustainable solutions. All these initiatives require an amalgamation of Leadership, Design Thinking, and Innovation in action, with multi-stakeholder perspective and sustainable solutions.

"The WeSchool ecosystem is designed to create in-depth understanding of sectors and domains and provide exposure to a breath of functions viz marketing, finance, operations, human resources, analytics, technology and design thinking models that apply across businesses and economies viz Healthcare, Retail, Rural markets, Media and Entertainment.

The philosophy is four-fold duty. First, start with the nation, then society, the organisation and then your family, including yourself. We cannot leave everything to the government; the responsibility to do something lies with each of us. We need to be Catalysts to the change we want to see."

Prof Dr Uday Salunkhe, Group Director, WeSchool (Mumbai and Bengaluru Campus)